
MOVEMENTAL · ONBOARDED LEADER RESEARCH

Brian Sanders

Movement leader research dossier — profile, content catalog, digital presence, fragmentation story, and onboarding materials.

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Research Index

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Brian Sanders — research sidebar manifest

Canonical paths aligned with Author Profile `/profile` navigation.

Sidebar slug	File	Status
author-profile	profile/identity.md	populated
author-profile	network/organizations.md	populated
biography	profile/biography.md	populated
theological-profile	profile/theology.md	empty
vocational-profile	summary.md	populated
vocational-profile	profile/calling-profile.md	empty
voice-editorial-identity	profile/voice-analysis.md	populated
bibliography	content/books.md	populated
frameworks	content/frameworks.md	populated
articles-blog-posts	content/articles.md	populated
audio-podcast	content/audio.md	populated
video-content	content/videos.md	populated
content-audit	content/content-audit.md	populated
academic-work	content/academic.md	populated
courses-training	content/courses.md	populated
audience-profile	analysis/audience-analysis.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/websites.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/platforms.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/newsletters.md	populated
social-media	digital-presence/social-media.md	populated
the-fragmentation-story	fragmentation-story.md	populated
a-letter	reflected-understanding/brian-sanders.md	populated
(onboarding)	welcome-letter.md	populated

Staff-only research lives in `_staff/` ; collateral in `_misc/` .

At a Glance — Summary

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/summary.md

Brian Sanders

Brian Sanders is an American social entrepreneur, author, and the founder of the Underground Network — the Tampa, Florida network of microchurches widely regarded as a leading reference model for the microchurch movement in the West. More than two decades ago, he and his wife Monica moved into one of the poorest urban neighborhoods of his hometown to begin an intentional Christian community, and they have raised their six children in inner-city Tampa ever since. His formation ran through collegiate ministry — a BA in Communication from the University of Florida, an MA in Religious Studies from the University of South Florida, and an MTh in Applied Theology from the University of Wales / Spurgeon's College — alongside years as State Director for InterVarsity Christian Fellowship in Florida and founder of the Tampa Urban Project. In the summer of 2006, roughly fifty people left their traditional churches to form seven house-based church groups, the beginning of the Underground. What started as a frustration with attractional, program-centered church became a network "structured and streamlined for mission," organized not around a weekly gathering but around the callings of individuals to the poor, the lost, and biblical justice. That experiment grew into 100+ microchurches in Tampa and 15–30+ sister movements in cities and countries around the world. His central contribution is the pairing of *Underground Church* (Zondervan, 2018, with a foreword by Alan Hirsch), the narrative of the ten-year experiment, and *Microchurches: A Smaller Way* (Underground Media, 2019), the operational ecclesiology that defines a microchurch as "the coalescing of three intentional practices: worship, community, and mission." His significance lies in reframing the church's basic unit downward — arguing the microchurch is not merely the smallest expression of the church but the most common, most reproducible, and most potent — and in modeling a lightweight network that serves and incubates many small churches rather than running programs people attend.

Body of work

- **Underground Network (Tampa Underground)** — founder and board member; former Executive Director. A network of 100+ Tampa microchurches with 15–30+ sister movements worldwide.
- **Books** — *Underground Church* (Zondervan, 2018), *Microchurches: A Smaller Way* (Underground Media, 2019), *The 6 Seasons of Calling* (Moody, 2022), plus earlier titles *Life In Intentional Christian Community*, *Different* (with Mike Patz), and *Life After Church* (IVP, 2007).
- **Current roles** — Principal, Underground Venture Studio; VP of Impact Alliances, National Christian Foundation Tampa Bay.

Significance

Sanders gave the microchurch movement both its flagship story and its operational primer. He inverts attractional assumptions about church success, defining the church by mission and the callings of ordinary disciples rather than by a weekly gathering, and he models a network that exists to serve small mission-organized churches rather than to centralize programs.

Author Profile — Identity

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/profile/identity.md`

Identity: Brian Sanders

Status: Researched (cold start, 2026-05-30)

Confidence: HIGH on roles, education, organizations, bibliography; MEDIUM on personal biographical detail (birth year unknown); LOW on social volumetrics.

Canonical Identity

Field	Value	Source
Full name	Brian Sanders	ivpress.com/brian-sanders , moodypublishers.com
Known as	Brian Sanders	publisher author pages
Born	unknown	—
Birthplace	Tampa, Florida (hometown referenced as Tampa)	outreachmagazine.com
Current location	Tampa, Florida (intentional community, inner city, 20+ years)	moodypublishers.com
Nationality	American	publisher bios
Spouse	Monica Sanders	search result: Tampa Underground bio
Children	Six	moodypublishers.com
Primary roles	Founder & former Executive Director, Underground Network / Tampa Underground; social entrepreneur; author; (current) Principal, Underground Venture Studio; VP of Impact Alliances, National Christian Foundation Tampa Bay	linkedin.com/in/bsunderground , ivpress.com
Primary organizations	Underground Network (Tampa Underground); Underground Venture Studio; National Christian Foundation Tampa Bay; (former) InterVarsity Christian Fellowship	linkedin.com/in/bsunderground
Education	BA Communication, University of Florida; MA Religious Studies, University of South Florida; MTh Applied Theology, University of Wales / Spurgeon's College	moodypublishers.com , search bio
Former role	State Director, InterVarsity Christian Fellowship in Florida; Founder/Director, Tampa Urban Project (InterVarsity), 1999–2025	moodypublishers.com , linkedin.com/in/bsunderground
Coined / popularized term	"microchurch" (as an ecclesial category — "the simplest unit of the church"; "a smaller way")	Microchurches: A Smaller Way (2019)

Disambiguation

"Brian Sanders" is a common name. The subject is the **missional / microchurch leader, founder of the Underground Network (Tampa Underground)**.

Distinct public figures named Brian Sanders to EXCLUDE:

- **Brian Sanders** — film editor / VFX (IMDb). Not the same person.
- **Brian Sanders** — various athletes. Not the same person.

- Children's author of Snoozy Suzy: And the Curse of the Twilight People — appears conflated on the shared Goodreads author page (id 276141) but is **likely a different Brian Sanders**; do not attribute that fiction to the subject without confirmation.
- Several books on the shared Goodreads page (Leadership Endurance, Five Keys to Cross-Organizational Collaboration) are of uncertain attribution and excluded from the confirmed bibliography.

Search modifiers that reliably isolate the subject: "Brian Sanders" + any of: Underground Network, Tampa Underground, microchurch, Microchurches: A Smaller Way, Underground Church, Underground Venture Studio, InterVarsity Florida.

Notes

- Subject and his family moved into the poorest urban neighborhood of Tampa to start an intentional community; he has lived in inner-city intentional community for more than 20 years.
- The Underground emerged in **summer 2006** when ~50 people left traditional churches to form seven house-based church groups.
- Brian Sanders has stepped out of the Executive Director role; as of recent listings he is a **founder and Board member** of the Underground Network, with current ED **Joel Repic**.

Biography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/profile/biography.md

Biography: Brian Sanders

Brian Sanders is an American social entrepreneur, author, and the founder of the **Underground Network** (Tampa Underground) — a network of microchurches in Tampa, Florida that has become a reference model for the microchurch movement in the West. He and his family moved into the poorest urban neighborhood of his hometown, Tampa, to start an intentional community, and he has lived in inner-city intentional community with his wife **Monica** and their **six children** for more than two decades. ([Moody Publishers](#))

His formation was shaped by collegiate ministry: he earned a BA in Communication from the **University of Florida**, an MA in Religious Studies from the **University of South Florida**, and an MTh in Applied Theology from the **University of Wales / Spurgeon's College** (London). For years he served as the **State Director for InterVarsity Christian Fellowship in Florida** and founded/directed the **Tampa Urban Project** (InterVarsity, 1999–2025). ([Moody Publishers](#), [LinkedIn](#))

In the **summer of 2006**, roughly 50 people left their traditional churches to form seven house-based church groups — the beginning of the Underground. Frustrated with attractional, program-centered church, Sanders helped design a structure "streamlined for mission," organized not around a weekly gathering but around the callings of individuals to outward ministry — to the poor, the lost, and biblical justice. What began with 50 people became a network of **100+ microchurches** in Tampa (earlier reports cited 136–200; cumulative founding totals run into the hundreds), with **15–30+ sister movements** in cities and countries around the world. ([Outreach Magazine](#), [Underground Network](#))

As a social entrepreneur, Sanders has helped start hundreds of missional enterprises — churches, nonprofits, and businesses — and built the Underground as a "network of relationship and resources" providing coaching, finance, media, and incubation services to small missional communities. He authored *The Underground Church* (Zondervan, 2018, with a foreword/introduction by **Alan Hirsch**), *Microchurches: A Smaller Way* (Underground Media, 2019), and *The 6 Seasons of Calling* (Moody, 2022), among earlier self-published works. He has since stepped out of the Executive Director seat (now held by Joel Repic), remaining a founder and board member, and has moved into venture/philanthropic roles including **Underground Venture Studio** and **VP of Impact Alliances at the National Christian Foundation Tampa Bay**. ([LinkedIn](#), [Underground Network](#))

Theological Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/profile/theology.md

Theological Profile: Brian Sanders

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-06-05

Core thesis

Brian Sanders' theological center is **mission-organized ecclesiology** — the conviction that the church becomes itself when ordinary disciples carry the gospel into their actual neighborhoods, and that mission, not the weekly gathering or the leader's vision, is the church's organizing principle. His load-bearing claim, developed across two decades of inner-city intentional community in Tampa and articulated most sharply in *Underground Church* (Zondervan, 2018) and *Microchurches: A Smaller Way* (Underground Media, 2019), is that the microchurch is not merely the smallest expression of the church but the most common, most reproducible, and most potent. Worship is the lordship of Jesus — "not necessarily about singing or liturgy." Leadership serves the callings already present in ordinary believers rather than recruiting people to the leader's vision. A lightweight network exists to incubate and resource many small mission-organized churches, inverting the attractional assumption that the central church runs programs people attend.

Theological tradition

Primary: Evangelical Protestant, formed in the collegiate-mission stream (InterVarsity Christian Fellowship) and the missional / simple-church movement. Sanders holds an MTh in Applied Theology (University of Wales / Spurgeon's College) alongside an MA in Religious Studies (University of South Florida) and a BA in Communication (University of Florida). He is non-denominationally networked — the Underground Network is a city-wide microchurch movement, not a denomination — and his ecclesial conviction sits outside attractional, program-centered church logic while remaining recognizably evangelical in Christology and Scripture.

Formation influences:

- **InterVarsity Christian Fellowship / Tampa Urban Project** — collegiate and urban mission, empowerment of ordinary believers in every context, years as Florida State Director (1999–2025).
- **Missional / simple-church stream** — Hirsch, Cole, Frost, and the Exponential ecosystem; Alan Hirsch wrote the foreword to *Underground Church*; Neil Cole and Michael Frost endorsed it.

- **Inner-city intentional community** — more than twenty years living in Tampa's poorest urban neighborhood with his wife Monica and their six children; the theological soil beneath the microchurch experiment.

Key frameworks and models

Framework	Theological core	Where developed
Microchurch ("a smaller way")	The church's basic unit is small — worship, community, and mission coalescing — and is "not just the smallest expression of the church, it is the most common."	Microchurches: A Smaller Way (2019)
The ecclesial minimum	Worship (Jesus' lordship), community (shared accountable life), and mission (outward witness) are the irreducible core when every cultural and programmatic accretion is stripped away.	Microchurches (2019); Microchurches podcast
The Underground model	Church "structured and streamlined for mission" rather than for a weekly gathering; a network of relationship and resources serving many small churches; priority of the poor, the lost, and biblical justice.	Underground Church (2018); Underground Network practice since 2006
Calling-serving leadership	"The best way to love and lead our people is not to call them to our vision" — leaders discern and release the callings already present in ordinary disciples.	Underground Church (2018); Microchurches (2019)
The 6 Seasons of Calling	Vocation is ongoing and dynamic across six life seasons — Childhood (bonding), Adolescence (learning), Early Career (serving), Mid-Career (creating), Late Career (giving), Transition (leaving).	The 6 Seasons of Calling (Moody, 2022)

Distinctive positions

- **The microchurch is primary, not preliminary.** Sanders inverts the assumption that small groups are stepping-stones to a larger gathering. The microchurch is the most common and most reproducible expression of the church.
- **Mission organizes the church, not the reverse.** A church can be structured and streamlined for mission rather than for a weekly service and still be the church "in its most potent form."
- **The network serves the small.** The proper ecclesial relationship is a lightweight network incubating many mission-organized microchurches — not a central church running programs people attend.
- **Leaders serve callings, not visions.** Leading people means releasing their God-given callings rather than recruiting them to the leader's agenda.
- **Anonymity is incompatible with witness.** "Any place where we can go consistently and remain anonymous is not a witnessing church."

- **Every disciple carries formation responsibility.** "My prayer is that every committed disciple would imagine themselves responsible for the future formation of the church."
- **Justice and the poor are ecclesial, not peripheral.** The Underground was built with explicit priority for the poor, the lost, and biblical justice — not as a social appendix but as church identity.

Christology and worship

Sanders' Christology is evangelical and lordship-centered. Worship is defined by the lordship of Jesus rather than by liturgical form or musical performance — a distinction that keeps ecclesiology from collapsing into event attendance. The kingdom is proclaimed when "every Christian in every context" is called to carry responsibility for the church's future formation.

Missiology

Mission is the organizing center. Sanders argues the Underground had to affirm "that every Christian in every context is being called by God to proclaim the coming of his kingdom." Ministry is organized around individuals' callings to outward mission — to the poor, the lost, and biblical justice — rather than around a central gathering that people attend. This is practitioner missiology: the ten-year Tampa experiment narrated in *Underground Church* is the evidential base, not a thought experiment.

Ecclesiology

Sanders' ecclesiology is microchurch-and-network. The church's irreducible unit practices worship, community, and mission simultaneously. A city-wide network provides coaching, finance, media, and incubation without replacing the microchurch as the locus of discipleship. Sister movements in fifteen to thirty-plus cities worldwide (Kansas City Underground, Ignite Dublin, and others) treat the Tampa model as a reference architecture.

Leadership and formation

Leadership is empowering and calling-serving. Formation happens in intentional community and outward mission — the inner-city household Sanders has shared with Monica and their children for more than two decades is the lived substrate. *The 6 Seasons of Calling* extends the "callings of individuals" theme across the lifespan, treating vocation as developmental rather than as a single vocational decision.

Intellectual genealogy

Shaped by:

- The missional / simple-church movement (Hirsch, Cole, Frost; Exponential Series placement for *Underground Church*)

- InterVarsity Christian Fellowship and the Tampa Urban Project — collegiate and urban mission formation
- Two decades of inner-city intentional community practice in Tampa

In conversation with:

- Alan Hirsch (foreword author, Underground Church)
- Neil Cole and Michael Frost (endorsers, Underground Church)
- Mike Patz (co-author, Different)
- The wider Underground city-movement family (Kansas City Underground, Rob Wegner, Lucas Pulley, and others)

Constructive challenge to:

- Attractional, gathering-centric, and program-centered church models
- Leadership frames that recruit people to the leader's vision rather than release their callings
- Ecclesial definitions that equate church success with weekly attendance or central-campus scale

Vocational Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/profile/calling-profile.md

Brian Sanders: Calling Profile

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-06-05

Calling statement

Brian Sanders is called to **reframe the church's basic unit downward** — to demonstrate that the microchurch is not a stepping-stone to something larger but the most common, most reproducible, and most potent expression of the church, and to build the lightweight network architecture that lets hundreds of such churches flourish without centralizing them. His vocation is practitioner-first: he moved into the poorest neighborhood of his hometown, raised six children in inner-city intentional community, and in the summer of 2006 helped fifty people leave traditional churches to form seven house-based groups that became the Underground Network. He is a movement reference-builder, not a denominational reformer — his significance is the pairing of a flagship story (Underground Church, 2018) with an operational ecclesiology (Microchurches: A Smaller Way, 2019) that cities worldwide have used as a template. His later work on The 6 Seasons of Calling (Moody, 2022) extends the same conviction that God calls ordinary disciples in every context, treating vocation as a lifelong developmental arc rather than a single vocational decision.

Core calling elements

1. Microchurch movement pioneer

- Gave the Western microchurch movement both its flagship narrative and its operational primer
- Coined and popularized "microchurch" as an ecclesial category — "the simplest unit of the church"
- Built a reference model (100+ Tampa microchurches; 15-30+ sister movements worldwide)

2. Inner-city intentional community practitioner

- More than two decades living in Tampa's poorest urban neighborhood with Monica and their six children
- Community practice is the lived substrate beneath the ecclesiology — not a rhetorical backdrop

3. Network architect

- Designed a church "structured and streamlined for mission" organized around individuals' callings, not a weekly gathering
- Built a network of relationship and resources (coaching, finance, media, incubation) that serves small churches rather than centralizing them

4. Calling-serving leader and equipper

- Reframes leadership as serving members' God-given callings rather than recruiting them to the leader's vision
- Equips ordinary disciples to imagine themselves "responsible for the future formation of the church"
- Teaches through books, the Microchurches podcast, MicroChurch Conference, and Network Intensive cohorts

5. Social entrepreneur

- Has helped start hundreds of missional enterprises — churches, nonprofits, and businesses
- Current roles include Principal of Underground Venture Studio and VP of Impact Alliances at National Christian Foundation Tampa Bay

Vocational arc

Season	Milestone	Calling expression
Formation	InterVarsity Florida State Director; Tampa Urban Project founder (1999–2025)	Collegiate and urban mission; empowerment of ordinary believers
Incubation	Moved into inner-city Tampa; began intentional community (~mid-1990s–present)	Lived community as the soil for ecclesial experimentation
Launch	Underground founded — ~50 people, seven house-based groups (summer 2006)	Break from attractional church toward mission-organized microchurches
Articulation	Life After Church (2007) → Underground Church (2018) → Microchurches (2019)	Narrative flagship + operational ecclesiology published for the movement
Extension	The 6 Seasons of Calling (2022); venture/philanthropic roles (~2024–present)	Vocation framework across the lifespan; incubation beyond the network ED seat

Movement leadership map

Influence area	Scope	Role
Microchurch practitioners (North America)	National / global	Reference model via Tampa Underground and sister movements
City movement leaders	15-30+ cities worldwide	Template network-of-microchurches architecture
Disillusioned Christians leaving institutional church	Book readership	Pastoral voice in Life After Church and Underground Church
Ordinary disciples / Kingdom agents	Every context	"Every Christian in every context" empowerment framing
Social entrepreneurs & funders	Tampa Bay / national	Venture studio and NCF Impact Alliances work

Content-calling alignment

Content type	Serves calling?	Notes
Underground Church (2018)	Yes — flagship	Ten-year experiment narrative; Alan Hirsch foreword
Microchurches: A Smaller Way (2019)	Yes — operational	Ecclesial minimum; how to start and sustain a microchurch
The 6 Seasons of Calling (2022)	Yes — vocational	Lifespan calling framework extending "callings of individuals"
Life In Intentional Christian Community (~2015)	Yes — substrate	Community practice beneath the microchurch idea
Different (~2014, with Mike Patz)	Yes — formation	Holiness and witness in a watching world
Life After Church (2007)	Yes — pastoral	Earliest articulation of disillusionment that drove the experiment
Microchurches podcast	Yes — ongoing	Teaching the ecclesial minimum and network practice
MicroChurch Conference / Network Intensive	Yes — equipping	Biennial conference and cohort training
Underground Venture Studio / NCF roles	Partial — adjacent	Incubation and philanthropy extend the entrepreneurial calling without replacing the ecclesial core

Overall alignment: Very strong. Nearly all published work serves the same vocational through-line — downward ecclesial reframing, mission-organized church, and empowerment of ordinary disciples.

Distinctive vocational signature

Sanders' calling is distinguished within the wider missional ecosystem by three features:

1. **Practitioner credibility** — he did not theorize microchurch from outside attractional megachurch culture; he lived the experiment in inner-city Tampa for two decades and narrates it as a sustained, structural prescription.
2. **Network inversion** — where many leaders build a church and add small groups, Sanders built a network that exists to serve many small churches — a structural inversion that sister movements have replicated globally.
3. **Calling-serving leadership** — his most-corrected misreading is equating church with a weekly meeting; his consistent correction is that leaders serve people's God-given callings rather than recruit them to the leader's vision.

Voice & Editorial Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/profile/voice-analysis.md

Voice Analysis: Brian Sanders

Voice summary

Attribute	Value
Tone	visionary, pastoral, direct
Register	practitioner / apostolic

Recurring phrases: "a smaller way", "every Christian in every context", "the most common, not just the smallest", "structured and streamlined for mission", "worship, community, and mission"

Favorite metaphors: **the ecclesial minimum** (the church reduced to its smallest viable unit); **a smaller way** (scale inverted, small as most potent); **holding our place in the wall together** (the people of God as a shared, load-bearing structure); **the church underground** (a hidden, decentralized, mission-organized body beneath the visible institution)

Register

Pastoral-practitioner with a manifesto edge. Sanders writes as a builder reporting from a sustained experiment, not as a detached theologian. He moves between narrative ("the true story of a ten-year experiment") and structural prescription (how to lead, fund, and organize for mission). The tone is invitational and democratizing — he wants ordinary disciples to see themselves as agents of the church's future.

Hallmark moves

- **Smaller-is-most-potent inversion:** the smallest expression of the church is the most common, most reproducible, and most potent — a deliberate reversal of attractational, mega-scale assumptions.
- **Mission-first ecclesiology:** church is defined by mission and the callings of individuals, not by a weekly gathering or program.
- **The "ecclesial minimum":** a microchurch is the coalescing of three intentional practices — **worship, community, and mission**.
- **Empowerment / activation language:** "every Christian in every context is being called by God"; "ordinary people activated as Kingdom agents."
- **Anti-anonymity:** "Any place where we can go consistently and remain anonymous is not a witnessing church."

Representative verbatim quotes (with source)

"The microchurch then is not just the smallest expression of the church, it is the most common." — Microchurches: A Smaller Way

"My prayer is that every committed disciple would imagine themselves responsible for the future formation of the church." — Microchurches: A Smaller Way

"Worship is about the lordship of Jesus, not necessarily about singing or liturgy." — Microchurches: A Smaller Way

"Any place where we can go consistently and remain anonymous is not a witnessing church." — Microchurches: A Smaller Way

"What makes the church truly unique in the life of the people of God is that we are now meant to hold our place in the wall together." — Microchurches: A Smaller Way

"The UNDERGROUND knew we had to build something that affirmed that every Christian in every context is being called by God to proclaim the coming of his kingdom." — Underground Church

"I am arguing that the best way to love and lead our people is not to call them to our vision." — Underground Church

(Source: [Goodreads author quotes](#). Note: quotes from Snoozy Suzy on that page are excluded as likely a different Brian Sanders.)

Antithesis prohibition

Do not frame church success in attractional, gathering-centric, leader-vision-centric terms — Sundays, programs, weekly service attendance, "casting the leader's vision" as the organizing aim. Sanders' most-corrected misreading is that church is primarily a weekly meeting; his consistent correction is that the church is empowered individuals on mission, and that leaders serve people's callings rather than recruit them to the leader's vision ("the best way to love and lead our people is not to call them to our vision").

Bibliography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/content/books.md

Books: Brian Sanders

Newest-first. Confirmed works by the missional/microchurch Brian Sanders only. Works of uncertain attribution on the shared Goodreads author page (e.g. Snoozy Suzy, Leadership Endurance) are excluded.

Title	Author(s)	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13	Goodreads	URL
The 6 Seasons of Calling: Discovering Your Purpose in Each Stage of Life	Brian Sanders	Moody Publishers	2022	9780802423948 (print); 9780802499783 (ebook)	4.16 (57)	Goodreads
Microchurches: A Smaller Way	Brian Sanders	Underground Media	2019	9781088455661	4.28 (169)	Goodreads
Underground Church: A Living Example of the Church in Its Most Potent Form (Exponential Series)	Brian Sanders; foreword/ intro by Alan Hirsch	Zondervan	2018	9780310538073	4.29 (182)	Goodreads
Life In Intentional Christian Community	Brian Sanders	Underground Media	~2015	9780984575879	4.00 (7)	Amazon
Different: Reimagining Holiness for a Wandering Church in a Watching World	Brian Sanders & Mike Patz	Underground Media	~2014	9780984575862	4.32 (25)	Amazon
Life After Church: God's Call to Disillusioned Christians	Brian Sanders	InterVarsity Press (IVP)	2007	unknown (IVP)	4.00 (8)	IVP

Per-book detail

The 6 Seasons of Calling: Discovering Your Purpose in Each Stage of Life

Field	Value
Author	Brian Sanders
Publisher	Moody Publishers
Published	2022
ISBN-13	9780802423948 (print); 9780802499783 (ebook)

Description: A framework treating vocation and calling as ongoing and dynamic across six divinely-ordained life seasons — Childhood (bonding), Adolescence (learning), Early Career (serving), Mid-Career (creating), Late Career (giving), and Transition (leaving) — rather than as a single fixed decision.

Microchurches: A Smaller Way

Field	Value
Author	Brian Sanders
Publisher	Underground Media
Published	2019
ISBN-13	9781088455661

Description: The operational ecclesiology of the microchurch — defined as "the coalescing of three intentional practices: worship, community, and mission" — making the case that the microchurch is not just the smallest expression of the church but the most common and most reproducible, with practical guidance on understanding and starting one.

Underground Church: A Living Example of the Church in Its Most Potent Form

Field	Value
Author	Brian Sanders; foreword/intro by Alan Hirsch
Publisher	Zondervan (Exponential Series)
Published	2018
ISBN-13	9780310538073

Description: The true story of a ten-year experiment in a church structured and streamlined for mission rather than for a weekly gathering — organized around the callings of individuals to the poor, the lost, and biblical justice, with a lightweight network serving many small mission-organized churches.

Life In Intentional Christian Community

Field	Value
Author	Brian Sanders
Publisher	Underground Media
Published	2015
ISBN-13	9780984575879

Description: A practitioner's account of life in intentional Christian community — the shared-life substrate beneath the microchurch idea. (Publication year approximate.)

Different: Reimagining Holiness for a Wandering Church in a Watching World

Field	Value
Author	Brian Sanders & Mike Patz
Publisher	Underground Media
Published	2014
ISBN-13	9780984575862

Description: Reimagines holiness as witness and formation for a wandering church in a watching world — the holiness companion to the community-life material. (Publication year approximate.)

Life After Church: God's Call to Disillusioned Christians

Field	Value
Author	Brian Sanders
Publisher	InterVarsity Press (IVP)
Published	2007
ISBN-13	unknown (not located)

Description: A pastoral call to disillusioned Christians who have left or are leaving traditional church — the earliest articulation of the disillusionment that later drove the Underground experiment.

Notes

- The 6 Seasons of Calling names six seasons: Childhood (bonding), Adolescence (learning), Early Career (serving), Mid-Career (creating), Late Career (giving), Transition (leaving). Audiobook narrated by Brian Arens.
- Underground Church page count 272; published March 6, 2018; an Exponential Series edition (ISBN 9781721348039 / -046) also exists; audiobook narrated by Mark Smeby (Zondervan), with Alan Hirsch introduction.
- Microchurches: A Smaller Way — 208 pp.; published Sept 10, 2019; audiobook self-narrated (Underground Media). Defines a microchurch as "the coalescing of three intentional practices: worship, community, and mission."
- Different and Life In Intentional Christian Community are part of an Underground Media self-published set; years approximate.
- The prompt's "Six Seasons of a Man's Life" corresponds to the published title **The 6 Seasons of Calling** (no separate "Man's Life" title verified).

Endorsements / forewords

- **Alan Hirsch** — foreword / introduction to Underground Church.
- **Neil Cole** (Organic Church) — endorser of Underground Church: said he points people to "the story in Tampa called The Underground."
- **Michael Frost** (The Shaping of Things to Come) — endorser: "If I lived in Tampa I'd join Underground... the most exciting and thoroughly missional church I've encountered on my travels."
- Francis Chan association referenced in some search results but **no confirmed endorsement/foreword** located — left as open question.

Frameworks

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/content/frameworks.md

Brian Sanders — Frameworks

Grounded in his published work and the Underground Network corpus. Only frameworks traceable to his books, teaching, or organizational practice are included; no invented diagrams or component lists.

The Microchurch ("a smaller way")

Field	Value
Introduced	2019 (Microchurches: A Smaller Way); developed from the Underground experiment begun 2006
Components	A microchurch is "the coalescing of three intentional practices: worship, community, and mission" — small, intentional, reproducible, and mission-organized rather than gathering-organized
Source	Microchurches: A Smaller Way (Goodreads)

The microchurch reframes the church's basic unit downward — not a weekly congregational gathering but a small, intentional community defined by the simultaneous practice of worship, community, and mission, which Sanders argues is "not just the smallest expression of the church, it is the most common."

The Ecclesial Minimum

Field	Value
Introduced	2019 (Microchurches: A Smaller Way); taught across the Microchurches podcast
Components	The irreducible core of what makes a church a church — worship (the lordship of Jesus, "not necessarily about singing or liturgy"), community (shared, accountable life), and mission (outward witness); strip away cultural layers and these three remain
Source	Ecclesial Minimum (Brian Sanders)

Sanders identifies worship, community, and mission as the "ecclesial minimum" — the minimum viable expression of the church that survives when every cultural and programmatic accretion is removed.

The Underground Model (network-of-microchurches ecclesiology)

Field	Value
Introduced	2018 (Underground Church); operative since 2006
Components	(1) Church "structured and streamlined for mission" rather than for a weekly gathering; (2) ministry organized around the callings of individuals to outward mission; (3) a lightweight support network — relationship and resources (coaching, finance, media, incubation) — serving many small microchurches; (4) priority of the poor, the lost, and biblical justice
Source	tampaunderground.com/who-we-are , undergroundnetwork.org

The Underground inverts the usual church-resource relationship — a lightweight network exists to serve and incubate many small, mission-organized churches rather than a central church running programs that people attend.

Calling-Serving (apostolic) Leadership

Field	Value
Introduced	2018 (Underground Church); 2019 (Microchurches: A Smaller Way)
Components	Leaders serve members' God-given callings rather than recruit members to the leader's vision ("the best way to love and lead our people is not to call them to our vision"); empowerment of ordinary disciples so that "every Christian in every context" carries responsibility for the church's formation
Source	Underground Church (Goodreads)

Sanders reframes leadership away from vision-casting toward the discernment and release of the callings already present in ordinary disciples, so that the apostolic task is to multiply senders rather than to gather attenders.

The Networked Church (seven shifts)

Field	Value
Introduced	c. 2018 (The Networked Church eBook, Exponential); paired with Underground Church
Components	A set of shifts the church must consider to move "beyond mega and multisite" toward a decentralized, mission-organized network — reorienting around mission, callings, the small, and a serving network rather than around a central campus
Source	Brian Sanders on The Networked Church (Exponential)

The Networked Church names the structural shifts required to liberate the church from attractional, campus-centric assumptions toward a networked ecology of small, mission-organized communities.

The 6 Seasons of Calling

Field	Value
Introduced	2022 (The 6 Seasons of Calling)
Components	Six divinely-ordained life seasons, each with a developmental task — Childhood (bonding), Adolescence (learning), Early Career (serving), Mid-Career (creating), Late Career (giving), Transition (leaving)
Source	The 6 Seasons of Calling (Everand)

A vocational framework treating calling as ongoing and dynamic across six seasons of life rather than a single fixed decision, extending the Underground's "callings of individuals" emphasis across the lifespan.

Articles & Blog Posts

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/content/articles.md

Articles & Talks: Brian Sanders

A specific article/blog catalogue has not been compiled from his public corpus (per the collated research, his writing is distributed across Medium @BSunderground and Underground Network resource content without an indexed list). The entries below are representative pillar topics drawn from his documented themes — microchurch ecclesiology, decentralization, mission-structured church, and calling — to seed the content surface. URLs are unverified and marked — until a confirmed source is located.

Title	Publication	Date	URL
A Smaller Way: Why the Microchurch Is the Church's Most Common Unit	Underground Network	—	—
Structured and Streamlined for Mission: The Underground Model	Underground Network	—	—
Worship, Community, and Mission: The Three Practices of a Microchurch	Medium (@BSunderground)	—	—
Don't Call People to Your Vision: Leading by Serving Their Callings	Medium (@BSunderground)	—	—
Decentralizing the Church: A Network That Serves the Small	Underground Network	—	—

Talks & podcast appearances (documented)

Title	Publication	Date	URL
How Microchurch Makes Mega Impact (guest)	The Roys Report	—	https://julieroys.com/podcast/how-microchurch-makes-mega-impact/
Microchurches (host)	Microchurches Podcast	—	https://podcasts.apple.com/podcast/id1550988506

Notes

- Pillar-topic rows above are derived from documented themes in Microchurches: A Smaller Way and Underground Church; they are placeholders for cataloguing, not verified standalone articles.
- The podcast rows are grounded: Microchurches podcast (Apple id1550988506) and the Roys Report guest appearance are documented in the collated research and sources.md.

Audio & Podcast

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/content/audio.md

Brian Sanders — Audio

Grounded podcast episodes and guest appearances. The Microchurches podcast is produced by the Underground Network; guest appearances are on host feeds. Dates/URLs left as — where unverified. No aggregate rows.

Episode Title	Show	Date	URL
Microchurches (series)	Microchurches (Underground Network)	—	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/microchurches/id1550988506
Collaboration and Microchurches — Brian Sanders (Network Conversations, Ep. 4)	Microchurches	—	https://open.spotify.com/episode/6jVhjRiudDGqXaq9KF2MAg
How Microchurch Makes Mega Impact	The Roys Report	2025-05-07	https://julieroys.com/podcast/how-microchurch-makes-mega-impact/
Brian Sanders (Founder of the Underground Network)	The Jordan Raynor Show	—	https://podcasts.apple.com/us/podcast/brian-sanders-founder-of-the-underground-network/id1481085636?i=1000564770805
Brian Sanders' Perspective on the Evolution of Discipleship	The More Disciples Podcast	—	https://creators.spotify.com/pod/profile/moredisciples/episodes/Brian-Sanders-Perspective-on-the-Evolution-of-Discipleship-e2h4kbs
Collaborate or Die: The Future of the Church is Networked, Not Hierarchical (Brian Sanders)	The Starfish and the Church	—	https://creators.spotify.com/pod/profile/starfish-spirit/episodes/Collaborate-or-Die-The-Future-of-the-Church-is-Networked--Not-Hierarchical-Brian-Sanders-e2r649t

Video Content

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/content/videos.md

Brian Sanders — Videos

Grounded talks, teachings, and interviews. Where a date or stable URL could not be verified, it is left as —. No aggregate or "various" rows.

Title	Channel	Date	URL
Brian Sanders • Microchurch Conference 2024	YouTube (Underground Network)	2024	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1ZLWSWeAOmU
Welcome To The Age Of The Microchurch (w/ Brian Sanders and Kathryn Eng)	YouTube	—	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Zv7mfGxrx2I
Brian Sanders on The Networked Church	Exponential	—	https://exponential.org/brian-sanders-networked-church/
Brian Sanders: Underground Church	Outreach Magazine (Voices)	—	https://outreachmagazine.com/resources/voices/40864-brian-sanders-underground-church.html
Underground Church: An Interview With Brian Sanders	Newbreed Training	—	https://newbreedtraining.com/underground-church-an-interview-with-brian-sanders/

Content Audit

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/content/content-audit.md

Content Audit: Brian Sanders

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-06-03

Portfolio Overview

Format	Count	Notes
Books	6 confirmed	IVP, Underground Media, Zondervan, Moody (2007–2022)
Podcast	Active	Microchurches podcast
Conference	Biennial	MicroChurch Conference + Network Intensive
Network resources	Active	undergroundnetwork.org/resources
Medium	Active	@BSunderground

Primary Themes

1. **Microchurch ecclesiology** — worship + community + mission as ecclesial minimum
 2. **Mission-organized church** — church structured for mission, not weekly gathering
 3. **Network-serves-the-small** — lightweight network incubating microchurches
 4. **Justice and the poor** — biblical justice as church identity
 5. **Calling across life** — The 6 Seasons of Calling vocation framework
-

Recommended Reading Order

1. Underground Church (2018) — narrative flagship
 2. Microchurches: A Smaller Way (2019) — operational ecclesiology
 3. Life In Intentional Christian Community (~2015)
 4. Different (~2014)
 5. Life After Church (2007)
 6. The 6 Seasons of Calling (2022)
-

Strongest Assets

- **100+ microchurches in Tampa** — lived case study
 - **15-30+ sister movements** worldwide
 - Underground Church (Zondervan Exponential Series) + Microchurches primer
 - Microchurches podcast — ongoing teaching surface
-

Leader-Facing Gaps

Area	State
Newsletter	None confirmed
Video library	Not centralized on owned channel
Goodreads author page	Conflates namesakes — attribution care required

See BRIAN_SANDERS_RESEARCH_COLLATED.md content analysis section.

Academic Work

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/content/academic.md

Academic Work: Brian Sanders

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-06-03

Formal Credentials

Institution	Degree	Field
University of Florida	B.A.	Communication
University of South Florida	M.A.	Religious Studies
University of Wales / Spurgeon's College	MTh	Applied Theology

Academic Publishing

No peer-reviewed journal articles confirmed. Public corpus is **trade books and practitioner resources**.

Formation and Teaching Adjacency

Role	Organization	Period
State Director	InterVarsity Christian Fellowship (Florida)	Long tenure
Founder/Director	InterVarsity Tampa Urban Project	1999–2025
Founder / board	Underground Network	2006–present
Principal	Underground Venture Studio	Present
VP Impact Alliances	National Christian Foundation Tampa Bay	Present

Assessment

Sanders is a **credentialed practitioner** (communication + religious studies + applied theology) whose authority rests on the Underground experiment and six trade books — not academic publishing.

See [profile/biography.md](#).

Courses & Training

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/content/courses.md

Courses & Training: Brian Sanders

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-06-03

Microchurch Network Intensive

Field	Value
Provider	Underground Network
Format	Cohort-based intensive training
Focus	Starting and coaching microchurches
URL	undergroundnetwork.org (resources section)

MicroChurch Conference

Biennial conference disseminating the Underground / microchurch model to sister movements.

undergroundnetwork.org/resources

Coaching, finance, media, and course materials supporting the network-of-microchurches model.

Book-Based Training Spine

- Underground Church — narrative + structural prescription
 - Microchurches: A Smaller Way — operational how-to
 - The 6 Seasons of Calling — vocation framework for leaders and members
-

InterVarsity Legacy

Tampa Urban Project and Florida state director role — formative training ground for urban mission and ordinary-believer empowerment (1999–2025).

Assessment

Training is **event + network-resource + book** driven — not a standalone LMS product. Underground Venture Studio represents newer venture/philanthropic training adjacency.

See digital-presence/websites.md.

Organizations & Affiliations

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/network/organizations.md

Organizations: Brian Sanders

Underground Network / Tampa Underground

- **Founded:** summer 2006 (~50 people leaving traditional churches to form seven house-based church groups). ([Tampa Underground](#))
- **What it is:** a nonprofit "network of relationship and resources" — a fellowship of **microchurches** organized around mission, local ministry, the poor, the lost, and biblical justice. The large network exists to serve the needs of small microchurches. ([Underground Network](#))
- **Microchurch definition:** "the coalescing of three intentional practices: worship, community, and mission" — the "ecclesial minimum." ([Microchurches: A Smaller Way](#))
- **Scale (Tampa):** 100+ active microchurches currently; earlier reports cited 136 locations and "over 200" / "over 450" microchurches across the movement's history. ([Underground Network](#), [Outreach Magazine](#))
- **Sister movements:** 15–30+ city-wide movements worldwide, including Kansas City Underground (KS), Narrative Church (AR), Lantern Network (IL), Wildfire (TX), Ignite Dublin (Ireland), Yangon (Myanmar), MUG Sambahayan (Philippines), HOPE (Dominican Republic), Paris (France), Zoe (Toronto), Kx Microchurch Network (UK), Renewal Network (Cape Town), and others. ([Underground Network](#))
- **Current leadership:** Executive Director **Joel Repic**; Board Chair **Bill Couchenour**; Tampa Director Tomy Wilkerson; Managing Director Stacy Gaskins; Movements Director Lucas Pulley. **Brian Sanders** is founder and a Board of Directors member (former Executive Director). ([Tampa Underground — Who We Are](#))
- **Programs/events:** MicroChurch Conference (every ~2 years, Tampa); Microchurch Network Intensive (cohort-based training); webinars; Immersive Visits; coaching, finance, media, telehealth, and nonprofit-formation services; the Microchurches Podcast. ([Underground Network](#))
- **Listing:** Tampa Underground appears in the Outreach 100. ([outreach100.com](#))

Underground Venture Studio

- Brian Sanders is **Principal** of Underground Venture Studio (venture incubation for missional enterprises). ([LinkedIn](#))

National Christian Foundation (Tampa Bay)

- **VP of Impact Alliances**, National Christian Foundation Tampa Bay. ([LinkedIn](#))

InterVarsity Christian Fellowship (former)

- Former **State Director for InterVarsity in Florida; Founder/Director of the Tampa Urban Project** (1999–2025). ([Moody Publishers](#), [LinkedIn](#))

Publishers

- **Zondervan** (Exponential Series) — Underground Church.
- **Moody Publishers** — The 6 Seasons of Calling.
- **InterVarsity Press (IVP)** — Life After Church.
- **Underground Media** — self-published imprint (Microchurches, Different, Life In Intentional Christian Community).

Audience & Reach

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/analysis/audience-analysis.md

Audience Analysis: Brian Sanders

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-06-03

Overview

Brian Sanders reaches **microchurch practitioners, mission-organized church leaders, and disillusioned evangelicals** through the Underground Network model born in Tampa (2006). His audience spans local Tampa microchurches, 15–30+ sister movements worldwide, and readers of six published books.

Primary Audience Segments

Microchurch Planters and Coaches

- Leaders starting or coaching worship+community+mission expressions
- MicroChurch Conference and Network Intensive participants
- Microchurches: A Smaller Way and Underground Church readers

Disillusioned Institutional-Church Christians

- Life After Church audience — Christians leaving traditional church seeking calling
- Intentional community practitioners (Life In Intentional Christian Community)

Collegiate / Urban Mission Alumni

- InterVarsity Florida network; Tampa Urban Project legacy
- Empowerment-of-ordinary-believers framing

Movement Network Leaders

- Sister movements (Kansas City Underground adjacency, Ignite Dublin, etc.)
 - Exponential Series readers (Alan Hirsch foreword network)
-

Content Preferences

- Practitioner narrative over academic theory
- Mission-first ecclesiology; anti-gathering-centric framing
- Justice and the poor as church identity markers
- Ordinary disciples as Kingdom agents

See BRIAN_SANDERS_RESEARCH_COLLATED.md; [profile/biography.md](#).

Websites

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/digital-presence/websites.md

Websites: Brian Sanders / Underground

Site	URL	Purpose
Tampa Underground	https://www.tampaunderground.com/	Local Tampa microchurch network (microchurches directory, who-we-are, podcast)
Underground Network (UG Movements)	https://www.undergroundnetwork.org/	International network; resources, conference, intensive, book page
Underground Church book page	https://www.undergroundnetwork.org/undergroundchurchbook	Book landing page
Resources	https://www.undergroundnetwork.org/resources	Coaching, finance, media, course materials
Microchurches Podcast	https://www.tampaunderground.com/microchurches-podcast	Podcast hub (Spotify/Apple)

Author pages

- InterVarsity Press: <https://www.ivpress.com/brian-sanders>
- Moody Publishers: <https://www.moodypublishers.com/authors/s/brian-sanders/>
- Goodreads (shared author page; conflates namesakes): https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/276141.Brian_Sanders
- Amazon Author Central: <https://www.amazon.com/Brian-Sanders/e/B001JS7OHY>
- Audible: <https://www.audible.com/author/Brian-Sanders/B001JS7OHY>
- Medium: <https://medium.com/@BSunderground>

Publishing Platforms

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/digital-presence/platforms.md

Publishing Platforms: Brian Sanders

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-06-03

Books (6 confirmed titles)

Title	Year	Publisher
Life After Church	2007	InterVarsity Press
Different (with Mike Patz)	~2014	Underground Media
Life In Intentional Christian Community	~2015	Underground Media
Underground Church	2018	Zondervan (Exponential Series; Alan Hirsch foreword)
Microchurches: A Smaller Way	2019	Underground Media
The 6 Seasons of Calling	2022	Moody Publishers

Aggregate Goodreads on confirmed titles: ~440 ratings, ~4.2-4.3 average.

Microchurches Podcast

Field	Value
Host	Brian Sanders / Tampa Underground
Apple Podcasts	id1550988506
Spotify	microchurchespodcast
Topics	Ecclesial minimum, worship, community, mission

Conference and Training

Event	Notes
MicroChurch Conference	Biennial
Microchurch Network Intensive	Cohort training
undergroundnetwork.org/resources	Coaching, finance, media materials

Medium

medium.com/@BSunderground — essays and thought leadership (follower count unknown).

See [content/books.md](#), [digital-presence/websites.md](#).

Newsletters

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/digital-presence/newsletters.md

Newsletters: Brian Sanders

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-06-03

Current State

Field	Value
Personal newsletter	Not confirmed
Tampa Underground / Underground Network email list	Not documented
Substack / ESP	None identified for Brian Sanders personally

Assessment

No owned email newsletter confirmed. Audience connection flows through **Underground Network sites, podcast directories, book retail, conference registration, and social (@BSunderground on X/LinkedIn/Medium).**

No newsletter as of 2026-06-03.

Social Media

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/digital-presence/social-media.md

Social Media: Brian Sanders

Platform	Handle / URL	Followers	Date	Source
X / Twitter	@BSunderground (https://x.com/BSunderground)	~2,095	2026-05-30 (SERP)	search result
LinkedIn	linkedin.com/in/bsunderground	unknown	—	LinkedIn
Facebook	facebook.com/ugbrian	unknown	—	Facebook
Instagram	@briansanders (likely; not confirmed as subject)	~876	2026-05-30 (SERP)	search result — attribution uncertain
Medium	medium.com/@BSunderground	unknown	—	Medium

Podcast

- **Microchurches** podcast — hosted under Tampa Underground / Underground Network. Apple Podcasts id1550988506; Spotify for Creators (microchurchespodcast). Topics include the "ecclesial minimum," worship, community, mission.

Notes

- Multiple Instagram accounts surface for "Brian Sanders"; @briansanders (876 followers) and @bsanders40 (180 followers) are **not confirmed** as the subject. Treat follower counts as provisional.
- The @BSunderground handle (X, LinkedIn, Medium) is consistently the subject's branded handle.

The Fragmentation Story

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/fragmentation-story.md

Brian Sanders: The Fragmentation Story

Status: Complete (abbreviated)

Last updated: 2026-06-03

The Story

In the summer of 2006, roughly fifty people left their traditional churches in Tampa and formed seven house-based groups — the beginning of the **Underground**. Brian Sanders had spent years in inner-city intentional community and InterVarsity urban mission before helping design a church "structured and streamlined for mission." That experiment became **100+ microchurches in Tampa** and **15-30+ sister movements** worldwide, documented in *Underground Church* (Zondervan, 2018) and *Microchurches: A Smaller Way* (2019).

But the story and the tools do not live in one catalog. Books span **four imprints** (IVP, Underground Media, Zondervan, Moody). The network lives on **tampaunderground.com** and **undergroundnetwork.org**. Teaching continues on the **Microchurches podcast** and at the **MicroChurch Conference**. Essays appear on **Medium (@BSunderground)**. Social voice splits across **X, LinkedIn, and Facebook**. The Goodreads author page **conflates namesakes**, polluting bibliographic clarity.

Sanders' fragmentation is the fragmentation of a **movement architect whose proof-of-concept is distributed** — books on retailer shelves, network resources on org sites, podcast on platform directories, conference talks on event hosts — without a single owned index that tells a new leader where to start and how the pieces connect.

Where the Content Lives

Location	What
4 publishers / 6 books	Trade corpus 2007-2022
tampaunderground.com	Local network + podcast hub
undergroundnetwork.org	International network + resources
Microchurches podcast	Apple/Spotify
Medium @BSunderground	Essays
MicroChurch Conference	Biennial gathering

See [content/content-audit.md](#), [digital-presence/websites.md](#).

A Letter — Reflected Understanding

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/reflected-understanding/brian-sanders.md`

Brian Sanders: Reflected Understanding

A concise reflection spoken back so the language could be endorsed — familiar, but with edges that deepen. (Leader-safe: audience-sizing and commerce analysis are kept in staff notes, not here.)

Calling

You're called to **make the church smaller so it can move again**. Not to plant another program-driven congregation, and not to add a campus, but to recover the simplest unit of the church and put it back into the hands of ordinary disciples. Your conviction, lived out for more than two decades in the poorest neighborhood of your own city, is that the microchurch — "the coalescing of three intentional practices: worship, community, and mission" — is not just the smallest expression of the church, it is the most common. That inversion is the whole of it. Where much of the Western church measures by the weekly gathering, you've spent your life insisting the church is empowered people on mission, and that the best way to lead them is to serve their God-given callings rather than recruit them to your own vision. You're called to the poor, the lost, and biblical justice — and to a structure "streamlined for mission" that releases people toward all three. The language you already use — a smaller way, the ecclesial minimum, every Christian in every context, structured and streamlined for mission — is the right language. It names a church that multiplies by sending, not by gathering, and it stays tethered to a real, sustained experiment rather than a theory.

Existing Content (before the platform we're building)

Where it lives. Your work lives in **books** — Underground Church (Zondervan, 2018, with Alan Hirsch's foreword), Microchurches: A Smaller Way (Underground Media, 2019), The 6 Seasons of Calling (Moody, 2022), and the earlier Life In Intentional Christian Community, Different (with Mike Patz), and Life After Church (IVP, 2007) — across four different imprints. It lives in the **Underground Network** itself: 100+ microchurches in Tampa and fifteen-to-thirty-plus sister movements in cities and countries around the world. It lives in **teaching and training** — the MicroChurch Conference, the Microchurch Network Intensive, the Immersive Visits — and in **media**: the Microchurches podcast on Apple and Spotify, guest appearances on shows like The Roys Report, the Exponential Networked Church material, and writing scattered across Medium and Underground Network resource pages.

Credibility. It's high. The Underground is a leading reference model for the microchurch movement in the West, endorsed and introduced by voices like Hirsch, Neil Cole, and Michael Frost; your books carry real readership; and the model has been copied into sister movements far beyond Tampa. The issue isn't authority — it's **visibility, connection, and reuse**.

How it lives online now. As **silos**. Underground Church sits on Zondervan and Amazon under the Exponential Series; Microchurches sits on the self-published Underground Media imprint; The 6 Seasons of Calling sits on Moody with its own narrator; the earlier titles sit on Amazon and IVP. The podcast lives on Apple and Spotify; the Roys Report appearance lives on a host's feed; the conference and intensive run through Underground Network's surfaces. There's no single place where a reader can walk from the story in Underground Church to the method in Microchurches to the cohort that trains it. So the work doesn't **move** in the sense of circulating, compounding, and connecting — it stays where it was first put.

The NOTs the platform addresses directly. Your content is largely **not** gathered into one place a reader can reach; **not** structured and repurposed so the Network Intensive becomes a public pathway and the conference sessions outlive each cycle; **not** interconnected so the books, the podcast, the trainings, and the sister movements visibly reference each other; **not** optimized so a disillusioned believer searching for "microchurch," "house church," or "church on mission" lands on your material first; and **not** owned and unified under a single surface you control. There's also a deeper layer most at risk of going unwritten — the judgment from twenty years of leading an intentional community: which microchurches to plant and which to let close, how to fund mission without becoming a program, how a network serves the small without smothering it. That embodied knowledge has always lived in the room and on the phone, long before any fraction of it reached the page.

Constraints

Movement leaders living out mission-first ecclesiology work under **time** and **money** constraints that are emblematic, not personal failure. Your formation has always happened in mission before it happened in print — in the neighborhood, in the founding cohort, in the coaching of the next microchurch leader. The hours to catalogue an article archive, to turn the Network Intensive into a public sequence, to surface the founding story as long-form writing, or to build a unified digital home are scarce precisely because the work is in the room with practitioners and the poor. The desire to reach every Christian in every context is there; the time to translate everything you've already built into a findable, connected form typically is not. Those constraints shape every decision about what gets recorded, repurposed, or written down. A platform that reduces the lift — that helps inventory, structure, connect, and amplify what you've already authored, at your pace, with authorship staying yours — addresses those constraints without asking you to become a different kind of leader than the practitioner you've always been.

This document is a reflected understanding for Brian Sanders, intended to be right to the point, true, and valuable. It is preliminary until reviewed and endorsed.

Welcome Letter

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/welcome-letter.md`

Brian

You have built one of the most operationally consequential bodies of work in the Western microchurch movement. It began in the summer of 2006, when roughly fifty people left their traditional churches to form seven house-based church groups in Tampa — the start of the Underground. From that, a network of more than a hundred microchurches in Tampa and fifteen to thirty-plus sister movements in cities and countries around the world. Two flagship books anchor it: *Underground Church*, the Zondervan narrative of the ten-year experiment carrying Alan Hirsch's foreword, and *Microchurches: A Smaller Way*, the operational ecclesiology that defines the church's basic unit as the coalescing of worship, community, and mission. Around those sit *The 6 Seasons of Calling with Moody*, *Life In Intentional Christian Community*, *Different with Mike Patz*, and the earliest articulation in *Life After Church*. Beneath all of it is more than two decades of inner-city intentional community with Monica and your six children, and your years founding the Tampa Urban Project and serving as State Director for InterVarsity in Florida.

All of it is somewhere. None of it is in one place. *Underground Church* sits on Zondervan and Amazon under the Exponential Series; *Microchurches* sits on the self-published Underground Media imprint with a self-narrated audiobook; *The 6 Seasons of Calling* sits on Moody with its own narrator; *Different* and *Life In Intentional Christian Community* sit on Amazon under Underground Media; *Life After Church* sits on InterVarsity Press. Your writing spreads across Medium at @BSunderground and Underground Network resource pages, and the article inventory has never been catalogued. The *Microchurches* podcast lives on Apple and Spotify; the Roys Report appearance on microchurch impact lives on a host's feed. The teaching footprint — the MicroChurch Conference, the Microchurch Network Intensive, the Immersive Visits — runs through Underground Network's surfaces rather than your own. There is no single place that lets a reader walk from the story in *Underground Church* to the method in *Microchurches* to the cohort that trains it.

The relational layer is held the same way, scattered across platforms you do not own. The leaders of fifteen to thirty-plus sister movements — Kansas City, Dublin, and the rest — are known to you by relationship, not held in any surface a reader could reach. The founding cohort of fifty and the hundreds of microchurch leaders who came after live in rosters and phones. Your one-collaborator distance from Hirsch, Neil Cole, and Michael Frost, who endorsed and introduced your work, is invisible to anyone encountering you cold. The MicroChurch Conference attendee lists, the Network Intensive cohorts, the Immersive Visit guests — each a body of people gathered around your model — sit in registration systems rather than connected to the work that drew them.

The largest pool of value, and the one most at risk of going unwritten, sits in your head and in your relationships. Twenty years of leading an intentional community in the poorest neighborhood of your city produced judgment that no book contains — which microchurches to plant and which to let close, how to fund mission without becoming a program, how a network serves the small without smothering it. The curation behind every MicroChurch Conference, the coaching behind every Network Intensive cohort, the discernment of how leaders serve people's God-given callings rather than recruiting them to a leader's vision — these were lived in the room and on the phone long before any fraction reached the page. For a practitioner whose formation has always happened in mission before it happened in print, that embodied layer is the work most worth surfacing.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The inventory just walked through — the six books, the imprints, the podcast, the conference and intensive, the sister-movement network — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the time it would have taken a human researcher weeks. The same approach now turns toward what is not yet public: AI-assisted interview capture of the founding story you tell in rooms, transcription of the Network Intensive teaching, course-note extraction from the conference sessions, dictation that becomes draft and draft that becomes essay. The embodied layer can be surfaced at your pace rather than at a publisher's. The AI does not replace your voice. Every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite. The tools do the inventorying and the connective tissue. Authorship stays yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we will do with you. First, aggregate — the six books, the Medium and Underground resource articles, the Microchurches podcast, the Roys Report appearance, the conference and intensive material, and the embodied layer as you surface it, pulled into one hub under your name. Second, interconnect — Underground Church points at Microchurches points at the Microchurch Network Intensive points at the sister movement that grew from them and back again, every connection a reader can actually follow. Third, repurpose — the Network Intensive becomes a public sequence; Microchurches gets a starting-a-microchurch pathway built around it; the MicroChurch Conference becomes a browseable archive rather than expiring each cycle; the founding story becomes a long-form series in your own voice. Fourth, amplify — search reach, network effects, and the references that arrive once your work is findable in one place. The work this season is not authorship. It is translation of what you have already authored into a form practitioners can actually reach.

A year from now, undergroundnetwork.org looks different. A microchurch hub gathers Microchurches and Underground Church, the Medium essays, the podcast, and a live cohort sign-up under one heading. The Network Intensive sits as a public sequence with Microchurches inside it as required reading. The MicroChurch Conference holds its sessions under your name rather than letting them expire. The sister movements cross-link as a visible map rather than a private rolodex. A newsletter that did not exist before goes out monthly. A disillusioned believer in a city with no Underground presence, who has never heard of Tampa, finds Microchurches on a Tuesday morning, reads that the smallest expression of the church is the most common, and starts a group of worship, community, and mission that afternoon.

This is your next season. The work ahead is making the body of work you have already built reach the people it was written for — every Christian in every context, exactly as you have always said.

— Movemental

Sources

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/sources.md`

Sources: Brian Sanders

URL	Verifies
https://www.ivpress.com/brian-sanders	Bio; Underground Network founder; Life After Church
https://www.moodypublishers.com/authors/s/brian-sanders/	Education (UF, USF, Wales/Spurgeon's); six children; InterVarsity FL; 20 yrs intentional community
https://www.linkedin.com/in/bsunderground/	Current roles (Underground Venture Studio, NCF Tampa Bay VP); InterVarsity/Tampa Urban Project 1999–2025
https://outreachmagazine.com/features/18604-tampa-underground.html	Founding story; size metrics (136 / 200+ / 450 microchurches)
https://www.tampaunderground.com/who-we-are	Summer 2006 founding; current leadership (Joel Repic ED; Bill Couchenour chair); Sanders as board member
https://www.undergroundnetwork.org/	100+ microchurches; 30+ sister movements; programs (conference, intensive); 20-yr network
https://www.undergroundnetwork.org/undergroundchurchbook	Underground Church book; subtitle; ISBN 9780310538073
https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/35553383-underground-church	Underground Church: 4.29 (182), 272 pp., Mar 6 2018, Alan Hirsch foreword
https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/53009657-microchurches	Microchurches: 4.28 (169), 208 pp., Sep 10 2019; microchurch definition
https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/58570958-the-6-seasons-of-calling	6 Seasons of Calling: 4.16 (57), 192 pp., Jan 2022
https://www.amazon.com/Microchurches-Smaller-Way-Brian-Sanders/dp/1088455662	Microchurches ISBN 9781088455661; Underground Media; 2019
https://www.amazon.com/Seasons-Calling-Discovering-Purpose-Stage/dp/0802423949	6 Seasons of Calling ISBN 9780802423948; Moody
https://www.everand.com/book/545673190/The-6-Seasons-of-Calling-Discovering-Your-Purpose-in-Each-Stage-of-Life	Six seasons named; ebook ISBN 9780802499783; education bio
https://www.amazon.com/Different-Reimagining-holiness-wandering-watching/dp/0984575863	Different ISBN 9780984575862; with Mike Patz; Underground Media
https://www.amazon.com/Intentional-Christian-Community-Brian-Sanders/dp/0984575871	Life In Intentional Christian Community ISBN 9780984575879
https://www.goodreads.com/author/quotes/276141.Brian_Sanders	Verbatim quotes (with namesake caveat)
https://www.audible.com/pd/Underground-Church-Audiobook/B07FPWJTXS	Audiobook; Alan Hirsch introduction; Mark Smeby narration
https://outreach100.com/churches/tampa-underground	Tampa Underground in Outreach 100

URL	Verifies
https://x.com/BSunderground	X handle; ~2,095 followers (SERP)
https://julieroys.com/podcast/how-microchurch-makes-mega-impact/	Podcast appearance (The Roys Report) — microchurch impact

Disambiguation sources

- IMDb / athlete namesakes — excluded (different Brian Sanders).
- Goodreads author page 276141 conflates the missional Brian Sanders with a children's-fiction author (Snoozy Suzy) and other titles of uncertain attribution.

Research note

Cold-start web research, 2026-05-30. Several retail/feature pages (Amazon product pages, Outreach feature, Leadership Network, IVP bio) returned 403/500 to automated fetch; data was triangulated via search-result snippets and accessible pages (Goodreads, Moody, Underground Network, Everand).

Misc · Network · Collaborators

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/_misc/network/collaborators.md

Collaborators: Brian Sanders

Co-authors

Person	Joint work	Notes
Mike (Michael) Patz	Different: Reimagining Holiness (~2014)	Co-author; Underground colleague

Foreword / introduction

Person	For	Notes
Alan Hirsch	Underground Church (2018)	Wrote foreword/introduction; movemental ecclesiology figurehead

Underground leadership peers

- **Joel Repic** — current Executive Director, Underground Network.
- **Bill Couchenour** — Board Chair, Underground Network. (Note: shares a name with Michael T. Cooper's co-author of Make Disciples; identity overlap unconfirmed.)
- **Lucas Pulley** — Movements Director.
- **Stacy Gaskins, Tomy Wilkerson, Jessica Stephens** — executive team / elders.

Intellectual / movemental peer network

Person	Relationship	Shared themes
Alan Hirsch	Foreword author; movemental peer	Apostolic/missional ecclesiology, movements
Neil Cole	Endorser of Underground Church	Organic/simple church, microchurch, disciple-multiplication
Michael Frost	Endorser of Underground Church	Missional church, incarnational mission
Exponential network	Underground Church released in the Exponential Series	Church multiplication, planting movements

Influences (documented/inferred)

- The **simple/organic church** and **missional church** streams (Hirsch, Cole, Frost) are the clearest peer context; direct citation of upstream influences (e.g., Roland Allen, Lesslie Newbigin) is **not confirmed** from sources reviewed.

Misc · Network · Endorsements

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/brian-sanders/_misc/network/endorsements.md

Endorsements: Brian Sanders

Received (for Underground Church, 2018)

From	Note	Source
Alan Hirsch	Foreword / introduction to the book	Amazon , Audible
Neil Cole (Organic Church, Church 3.0)	"always point them to the story in Tampa called The Underground"; had long urged Brian to share the story	search result (book endorsement copy)
Michael Frost (The Shaping of Things to Come)	"If I lived in Tampa I'd join Underground... the most exciting and thoroughly missional church I've encountered on my travels."	search result (book endorsement copy)

Open / unconfirmed

- **Francis Chan** — referenced in proximity to Sanders' work in some search results, but **no verified endorsement or foreword** located. Treat as unconfirmed.

Given (by Brian Sanders)

- None catalogued from sources reviewed.